

why being a continuous learner and enhancing your skill in whatever arena you are in is imperative.

On the topic of learning, it's worth noting that rich people not only continue to learn, they make sure they learn from those who have already been where they themselves want to go. One of the things that made the biggest difference for me personally was whom I learned from. I always made it a point to learn from true masters in their respective fields—not those who claimed to be experts, but those who had real-world results to back up their talk.

Rich people take advice from people who are richer than they are. Poor people take advice from their friends, who are just as broke as they are.

I recently had a meeting with an investment banker who wanted to do business with me. He was suggesting I place several hundred thousand dollars with him to get started. He then asked me to forward him my financial statements so he could make his recommendations.

I looked him in the eye and said, “Excuse me, but don’t you have this backward? If you want me to hire you to handle my money, wouldn’t it be more appropriate for you to forward me *your* financial statements? And if you’re not really rich, don’t bother!” The man was in shock. I could tell that no one had ever questioned his own net worth as a stipulation for investing with him.

It’s absurd. If you were going to climb Mount Everest, would you hire a guide who’s never been to the summit before, or would it be smarter to find someone who’s made it to the top several times and knows exactly how to do it?

So, yes, I am absolutely suggesting you put serious attention and energy into continuously learning and, at the same time, be cautious of whom you are learning and taking advice from. If you learn from those who are broke, even if they’re consultants, coaches, or planners, there’s only one thing they can teach you—how to be broke!

By the way, I highly recommend you consider hiring a personal success coach. A good coach will keep you on track in doing what you’ve said you want to do. Some coaches are “life” coaches, meaning they handle the gamut of everything, while other coaches have specialties that might include personal or professional performance, finances, business, relationships, health, and even spirituality. Again, find out your prospective coach’s background to ensure the coach has demonstrated success in the arenas of importance to you.